



Figure 8: SCTP shutdown

There are six significant points in the shutdown-handshake scenario:

1. SCTP-user level application issues a `close()` at Node A. At this point, no new data can be sent from Node A.
2. The SCTP implementation at Node A has sent and received an acknowledgement for all queued data (before the close). At this point, the endpoint sends a SHUTDOWN chunk.
3. Node B receives the SHUTDOWN so the upper layer is

notified and no new data will be accepted for transmission.

4. Node B has received acknowledgment for all its queued data so it sends a SHUTDOWN-ACK.
5. Node A destroys the association/TCB and sends back a SHUTDOWN-COMPLETE.
6. Node B receives the SHUTDOWN-COMPLETE and destroys its association/TCB.

This is a clean and graceful closure of an association.

There is also an option of an 'ungraceful' shutdown using ABORT chunks. Discussions about this (and more) will be left for another day. 

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References

- www.sctp.org – Informative site; contains quality material for (non-)beginners.
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By: Srikantha Prasanna

The author likes his beard and handmade khadi clothes. In his leisure time he works for Nokia Siemens Networks, Bangalore. He can be reached via his Gmail id: srikantap.

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